Anand Avula

IAM Engineer | ForgeRock / Ping Identity (PingAM, PingIDM, PingDS, PingGateway)
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Professional Summary

ForgeRock-certified IAM Engineer (PT-AM-CPE) with 2.8+ years of hands-on experience across PingAM, PingIDM, PingDS and PingGateway. Led the 7.3.2 to 7.5.2 platform upgrade and owns Identity Gateway in the ongoing 8.1.1 upgrade. Builds authentication trees and self-service journeys with JavaScript, Groovy and REST APIs, backed by OAuth 2.0, OIDC, SAML 2.0, MFA and LDAP. Supports incident resolution, PingDS replication, SAML certificate renewals and disaster recovery.

Technical Skills

- **Ping Identity / ForgeRock Platform:** PingAM (ForgeRock AM), PingIDM (ForgeRock IDM), PingDS (ForgeRock DS), PingGateway (ForgeRock IG), ForgeOps, Authentication Trees, Realms, Adaptive Authentication
- **Identity Protocols and Standards:** OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect (OIDC), SAML 2.0, SSO, MFA, OTP Verification, Identity Federation, LDAP, REST APIs
- **Programming and DevOps:** Java, Groovy, JavaScript, JSON, Kubernetes, Docker, Jenkins (CI/CD), Git, GitHub, Postman
- **Monitoring and ITSM:** Splunk, Dynatrace, Grafana, Prometheus, ServiceNow, Incident and Change Management
- **IAM Capabilities:** Self-Service Journeys, Identity Lifecycle Management, User Migration, Platform Upgrades, Disaster Recovery, Certificate Management, PingDS Replication Monitoring and Troubleshooting
- **Documentation:** Technical and Design Documents, Requirements Analysis

Professional Experience

Software Engineer - IAM, Sechay Solutions, Hyderabad, India Mar 2024–Present

ForgeRock Platform Upgrade (7.3.2 to 7.5.2 to 8.1.1)

- Led the phased upgrade of the ForgeRock platform from 7.3.2 to 7.5.2, owning PingAM and PingIDM and coordinating PingGateway and PingDS team members.
- Resolved post-upgrade defects in OAuth 2.0 provider, authentication script and admin account configurations.
- Own PingGateway (IG) for the ongoing 7.5.2 to 8.1.1 upgrade, reporting status and risks to senior stakeholders.
- Built automation scripts to audit authentication trees and find unused scripts and nodes (such as redundant LDAP query nodes), with a dry run that reports counts before the actual run removes them from both AM and the GitHub repository.

Retiree Authentication and Self-Service (Phase 1 and 2)

- Designed and built from scratch an authentication journey for retired users covering email domain validation, email and mobile registration, OTP verification and secure login, reducing manual service desk requests.
- Led Phase 2: delivered registration, login, forgot-password and profile-update journeys, integrating REST APIs for identity verification and supporting legacy user migration and re-registration.

IAM Realm Consolidation

- Consolidated 8 realms into 3 by migrating applications, authentication trees and scripts across PingAM, PingIDM and PingDS.
- Decommissioned unused realms, applications and obsolete configurations.

Unique Email Restriction Enhancement

- Led an enhancement allowing one email address across multiple applications by updating PingAM authentication trees, reworking LDAP search and decision logic, and introducing feature flags for controlled rollout.
- Developed custom JavaScript for portal-based access validation and modified PingIDM scripts for email update and delete actions.

IAM Managed Services and Operations

- Resolve IAM incidents by priority in ServiceNow, using Splunk, Dynatrace, Grafana and Prometheus to monitor application health and perform root cause analysis.
- Monitor PingDS replication health (CTS and ID repository) during incidents and restore out-of-sync instances by reinitializing them from a healthy replica to keep authentication and sessions available.
- Run LDAP searches and modifications on PingDS to look up and update user entries and extract user data and metrics for stakeholders.
- Support SAML certificate renewal and replacement across environments to prevent federation outages.
- Support disaster recovery activities, including backup and restore of IAM environments.
- Author design, requirement and technical documentation for each project delivered.

Certifications

- Ping Identity (ForgeRock) Certified Professional – Access Management (PT-AM-CPE); currently learning PingOne Verify

Education

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering, Bharat Institute of Engineering & Technology 2019–2023